

Purpose Statement:

Orients the AI to project scope before any instructions, so each step is interpreted in context. Placement at intro b/c the AI reads top-down.

Governing Rules:

Global instruction for responding throughout the conversation. Sits outside of logic hierarchy. In a career context, telling someone what they "must" do ignores the fact that there are no concrete rules. Also sets language expectations.

Career Bio:

A document capturing interview responses about why someone does the work, so the AI has immediate context for tailoring.

Reverse Appendix:

Any section coming before the instructions acts like an appendix, used for reference to help the AI understand how to handle something. Comes first because the AI reads top down.

Initial Setup:

This section introduces the prompt and probes for bare minimum supporting documents to ensure the prompt runs correctly.

Individual Questions:

Asks questions one at a time because audiences have different comfort levels with technology. Also designed to reduce the cognitive burden of a purely text-based experience.

Prompt – Tailored Resume

Help me tailor my resume for a specific job by interviewing me about my experiences and then revising my bullets to align with what this employer needs. This prompt was written by someone other than me, so follow the instructions as described without additional commentary about where we are in the process, because I might not have read this prompt and might not know what to expect, so additional commentary might be distracting.

Governing Rule

Throughout this conversation, offer suggestions rather than directives. Use language that preserves uncertainty (e.g., "could" over "would," "suggests" rather than "indicates") and frame interpretations as possibilities rather than facts. Invite me to say so if anything in your analysis feels off. Use accessible language throughout — I might be unfamiliar with career jargon or the American job market. Use accessible language appropriate for early career applicants and international applicants in America who might be unfamiliar with career jargon. Be conversational, not clinical.

Career Bio Context

A Career Bio is a structured self-knowledge document that serves as the authoritative source of my professional identity, experiences, values, and voice. When provided alongside any career-related task, it should function as the primary context layer. The document centers on a "Professional Identity" statement ("The thing I want to be most recognized for is...") that acts as a north star for all outputs. It also contains VIPS-M elements (Values, Interests, Personality, Skills, Motivations), and key experiences. When I upload a Career Bio, use it to:

- Inform how I might describe my experiences, referencing my stated professional identity, values, and working style
- Surface tensions between my professional identity and how the resume currently frames my experiences – not to confirm alignment
- Use my own language from the Career Bio when reflecting things back to me

Do not summarize the Career Bio back to me or reference it in ways that feel like retrieval. Use it as context that shapes the conversation, not content to be reported. Do not draw information from the Career Bio unnecessarily for the sake of fulfilling this instruction. When a Career Bio is not shared, do not reference it again.

1. Initial Setup

Ask me for the following, one at a time:

Organizational Structure:

Numbered sections establish a logical hierarchy. Designed to help Claude chunk each section to easily keep track of where it's at.

Absolute References:

References organizational structure unambiguously. Helps the AI find exactly where it needs to be.

Silent Analysis:

When asking for an analysis, Claude tends to share the results of it. A job seeker will be overwhelmed by a wall of text when it gives them an analysis before seeing their resume. Later, Claude receives instructions for which parts of the analysis to include in the output.

Stylistic Mistakes Don't Always Matter:

This section of the **2. Silent Analysis** describes a specific bullet writing method. For consistency, it belongs outside the logical hierarchy at the beginning, but that's for the human. The AI still knows how to follow these

First Person Perspective:

The prompt is written in a first-person perspective with rich explanation. This is intentional. I want job seekers who read this prompt to learn from it and understand it so that they can easily edit it. Longer prompts can eat through conversation limits, but it's a strategic decision. Optimization doesn't always produce an effective user experience. The rich detail also helps models like Sonnet 4.5 and earlier achieve a high quality output and experience.

To start, please upload the job description."

1.2 Question 2

"Please paste or upload the job description analysis from **Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description** and the resume assessment from **Prompt 5. Assessing Your Resume's Fit**."

1.3 Question 3

"Please upload your current resume."

1.4 Question 4

"If you previously created a Career Bio, please upload that now. If not, we can work without it. Tell me 'don't have.'"

2. Silent Analysis

After receiving responses to questions **1.1** through **1.4**, silently confirm you have the job description (**1.1 Question 1**), the analysis from **Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description (1.2 Question 2)**, the assessment from **Prompt 5. Assessing Your Resume's Fit (1.2 Question 2)**, and my resume before proceeding. The Career Bio (**1.4 Question 4**) is optional; if I shared one, follow the guidance in the introduction. If the job description, analysis, assessment, or resume are missing, note what's missing and ask before continuing.

The revision plan from **Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description** suggested the overall shape with what to keep, reframe, demote, promote, or add. This prompt operates one level down: the bullets within each experience. The silent analysis below prepares for an interview that will surface the information needed to revise those bullets.

Bullets in this prompt are revised using the What, How, Why, Impact (WHWI) format:

Action verb + [what I did] by [how I did it] to [why I did it], resulting in [impact]

Where:

- **Action verb** = An impact verb (e.g., "directed", "presented", "analyzed", "designed") in the appropriate tense that communicates a clear action rather than a dead action word with ambiguous meaning (e.g., "Oversaw", "Looked at", "Helped with", "Supported"). Where possible and accurate to my experience, the action verb should match the action verbs used to describe the day-to-day work in the job description without becoming repetitive across bullets.
- **[What I did]** = My responsibilities, tasks, duties, or projects, in a short statement that builds off the action verb, mirroring the language of the job description where possible and accurate.
- **[How I did it]** = The concrete, named skills, tools, or resources I used, or who I collaborated with and how, mirroring where possible and accurate the language in the job description.

Prompt Sequencing:

Breaking prompts into a sequence is strategic. It ensures that the AI only knows one goal at a time, so that it doesn't take shortcuts to get there. Using multiple prompts also paces the audience. It creates a natural pause point if the process of answering questions is exhausting.

Priority Setting:

When someone says "Optimize these resume bullets for this job description", they're not telling the AI what to focus on, so it defaults to what the average person talking about resumes would look for. These instructions direct the AI to missing elements and where to look in the job description.

- **[Why I did it]** = What I hoped to accomplish or develop for the team, department, organization, or other stakeholder, connecting back to the strategic purpose of this specific job where possible and accurate. If the role is about maintaining, the why should reflect maintaining; if it's about building, the why should reflect building. The goal is to borrow language from the job description (**Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description, 1.2 Question 2**) where appropriate so that how I explain the strategic purpose of my accomplishments reflects my understanding of the strategic purpose of this role.
- **[Impact]** = What happened when I did it, either through quantified results or a qualified description of what the stakeholder could now do that they couldn't do before. The impact should also connect to the strategic purpose described in the why.

Not all elements need to flow as separate components. How and why can combine into a single phrase when a reasonable recruiter or hiring manager would consider them self-explanatory together. **4. Output** covers final formatting and language requirements.

Silently evaluate my resume against these questions. Do not share your analysis yet, and do not mention that you are performing a silent analysis (that defeats the point of being silent):

2.1 Revision Priorities

Using the revision plan from **Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description (1.2 Question 2)**, identify which experiences need the most work and which need the least. I might have made edits between **Prompt 4** and now, so assess if those critiques still hold true. Sequence them so the interview starts with the experience that needs the most revision and moves toward the ones that need less. Note any experiences that **Prompt 4** recommended adding from scratch (a project, volunteer work, a reframed role). Those likely need the most interview time because there's no existing bullet to work from.

2.2 Bullet-Level Diagnosis

For each experience, look at the current bullets and note:

- What each bullet currently communicates versus what this job likely needs it to communicate based on **Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description (1.2 Question 2)**
- Which WHWI elements (**2. Silent Analysis**) are present, missing, or misaligned
- Whether the bullet's action verb matches the daily work of this job or pulls in a different direction (**Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description, 1.2 Question 2**)

This diagnosis is what the interview will repair. The goal isn't to rewrite anything yet. The goal is to know what's not functioning well so the interview can target it.

Diminishing Returns:

A section designed to emphasize that not everyone needs to use AI for every single resume. The level of tailoring someone does for any given job hinges on the gap between where the resume currently is and where it needs to be to effectively communicate fit.



2.3 Diminishing Returns Check

If the diagnosis in **2.2 Bullet-Level Diagnosis** suggests my resume is already well-aligned with this job – most bullets have functioning WHWI elements, action verbs match the day-to-day work, and the resume already speaks to the business problem this role solves – pause before continuing to the interview.

Tell me what you found: which bullets already appear to be effective, where the remaining gaps are minor, and what specifically you would still want to ask about. Then ask whether I want to proceed with a full interview, focus only on the bullets that still have meaningful gaps, or stop here.



If I want to proceed fully, continue the silent analysis at **2.4. Interview Plan**. If I want a focused interview, narrow the interview plan to only the experiences with gaps a reasonable recruiter or hiring manager might find meaningful. If I want to stop, acknowledge that and end the session.

Subgoals:

Plainly stating the purpose of a specific section can help ensure the AI understands why it's important to do. Think of subsections as subprompts.



The goal is to avoid revising bullets that are already doing their job, since unnecessary revisions can introduce AI-pattern language or weaken phrasing that's working.

2.4 Interview Plan

For each experience, draft the questions that would surface the information needed to revise its bullets. Prioritize questions that fill gaps in the why and impact (often the weakest elements in untailored bullets) and questions that surface details about how the work was done that the current bullet leaves vague. If a bullet is already strong on what and how but missing why and impact, the interview should focus there rather than re-asking what the bullet already communicates well.

2.5 Career Bio Tensions

If I provided a Career Bio, note any places where my resume's current framing of an experience appears to contradict or underplay something I identified in my Career Bio as central to my professional identity that I could highlight here. These tensions are worth surfacing in the interview, not as confrontation, but as openings for me to reframe an experience around something that matters more to me than what the current bullet captures.

Interview Approach:

Asks questions one at a time. This paces the interview experience and also enables the AI to build one response on top of another, so that the interview experience is uniquely tailored and relevant to the individual.



3. Interview

3.1 Approach

Starting with the experience that needs the most revision, ask me questions one at a time to gather information for tailoring. Your goal is to understand not just what I did, but how my work connects to the day-to-day reality and why this specific job was created.



After each response, reflect back understanding of what I shared and its connection to the role before the next question. The purpose is to demonstrate shared understanding through active listening, giving me the opportunity to correct you if your interpretation

Active Listening:

Instructs the AI to use active listening, and then explains what that means in this context. Without that explanation, defaults to generic repetition of what the user just said. Performs active listening instead of doing it.

Question Focus:

The AI tends to gravitate toward direct questions that job seekers often don't know how to answer themselves. Directing the AI to use what it knows about the job seeker and the role to ask the question indirectly can produce more rich qualitative responses.



3.2 Question Focus

Frame questions to connect my experiences to what this job needs:

- Instead of “What did you do?”, ask “Looking at what this role involves — [paraphrase day-to-day reality] — what about your work at [company] connects to that?”
- Instead of “What was the impact?”, ask “What changed because of what you did there, and how does that relate to [paraphrase the business problem this role solves]?”
- Build on my current bullets: “Your resume mentions [X]. Can you tell me more about [specific aspect that would strengthen alignment with this job]?”

Bolding:

A personal-workflow decision to help with finding Absolute References. Bolding won't be visible to the AI.



For experiences that **Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description** recommended adding from scratch (a project, volunteer work, a reframed role), there's no existing bullet to build on. Open with broader scoping questions before drilling into WHWI elements:

- “**Prompt 4. Analyzing the Job Description** suggested adding a project that demonstrates [X]. Do you have one in mind? If so, tell me about it. What did you actually do day-to-day? What changed because you did it?”

Bracketing:

Some people use brackets to indicate the parts of a prompt that a user needs to edit. Any time you ask a user to edit a prompt, you're inviting opportunities to break the prompt if they do it improperly. I design all prompts to operate without additional modification. Brackets here signal to the AI what it needs to think about and modify when I'm telling it to insert text.



For experiences where **2.5 Career Bio Tension** surfaced a Career Bio tension (if available), frame the question around what I might want this experience to communicate, not what the Career Bio said. Example: “Your resume frames this role around [current angle]. Is that what you most want this experience to communicate, or is there a different angle that matters more to you? I ask because your Career Bio described your professional identity as [paraphrase professional identity statement]”

Response Handling:

Unexpected responses will happen. Instructions that anticipate those responses go a long way in maintaining a consistent experience.



If I say “I don't know” or give an incomplete response, acknowledge the difficulty of the question, then offer a few examples of how someone in a similar position might connect their work to this job. Then ask the question in a different way. If I again respond that I don't know, move on to the next question.

If something I share sounds unconventional or potentially difficult to include in a resume bullet, do not tell me what I can and can't say. Highlight that it appears unconventional, explain why, and offer an alternative framing or question. The decision about what to include is mine.

Pacing:

Reflecting is exhausting. Building in optional break points and explicitly instructing to vary the phrasing helps prevent the reminder from feeling repetitive.



3.4 Pacing

After a stretch of intensive questions and long conversational responses, or every 7 to 10 questions, whichever comes first, say something like: “This kind of reflection takes energy. Take a break

Pacing:

Reflecting is exhausting. Building in optional break points and explicitly instructing to vary the phrasing helps prevent the reminder from feeling repetitive.

Output:

Depending on the topic, my prompts typically have at least two sets of output instructions: the format and the content. Here and in other career-specific prompts, I also include a language requirements section that guides the logic of what is appropriate and inappropriate phrasing to anticipate the parts that commonly sound like AI. Inevitably, some conventions slip through the cracks, and that's why I encourage users to always treat every response from the AI, and especially the final output, as a rough draft that they need to scrutinize.

3.5 Closing the Interview

When questions for all experiences have been asked, before moving to drafting, ask: "Is there anything about your experience or background that didn't come up in these questions but that you'd want reflected in your resume?" After my response, confirm that drafting is about to begin and that the bullets will be a rough draft for me to refine.

4. Output

4.1 Output Format

Revise each bullet using the WHWI format from **2. Silent Analysis**. Each bullet should be less than approximately 2 lines of text or about 200 characters. Treat the connectors ("by," "to," "resulting in") as a guide to the general shape, not required language. Vary them across bullets to avoid the parallelism that signals AI generation.

4.2 Language Requirements

Do not use:

- Hyperbole or excessive adjectives
- Redundant intensifiers
- High buzzword density
- Self-assessment terms (proficient, exceptional, outstanding)
- Enthusiasm without personality
- Vague, non-specific accomplishments
- "Approximately", "about", "~", "+" or other signals for estimates — it is standard that what is written in a resume is an estimate
- Words that don't directly contribute to understanding what I did (e.g., "exceptional", "outstanding"), focusing only on words that serve a purpose for readers unfamiliar with my experience
- Perfect parallelism or other patterns that signal AI generation
- Em dashes or endashes
- Made up facts or experiences

Do use:

- Short, natural-sounding sentences with simple words
- Paraphrasing of actual language and phrasing
- Language from the job description, where mirroring it accurately reflects the work I did
- Concrete, specific details I provided

Output Type:

I waffle on requiring an artifact or .docx. When I use this prompt for my own job search, I often write out this instruction because I manually type out whatever the AI recommends to ensure I have command of every word that makes it into the final output. However, some people prefer having a document they can work with. This anticipates that.

Output Intro:

Having an intro to the output helps orient users when the conversation suddenly shifts from an interview to output.

The Actual Output:

Here, you'll notice that the interviewing experience resulted only in tailoring resume bullets. It doesn't touch on skills, education, or a professional introduction.

When I use this prompt for personal use, I add instructions to check those things too. Here, my goal is to help job seekers with one specific aspect of tailoring their resume. They still need to think about what to say for the other parts, and they know where to find my team for additional support.

4.3 Output Content

If the settings are enabled, create an artifact or .docx titled "Tailored Resume Bullets." If not, output as text in the chat window. After the title of this section, include this statement: "These bullets are tailored to [Company Name] — [Job Title]. They emphasize aspects of your experience that align with the operational reality and strategic purpose of this role. Treat these bullets as a rough draft. Edit them for accuracy before copying and pasting them into your resume. What Claude created might sound good at first glance but feel wrong when inspected thoughtfully. Revise them manually or meet with a Career Coach for additional support

Then, for each experience, format as:

[Company name], [City/State], [Start – End Month, Year]
[Role title]

- [Revised bullet 1]
- [Up to four additional bullets as warranted by the interview]